



Scorpion CVR(T)

The design of the Scorpion dates to the 1960s, when both tracked and wheeled reconnaissance vehicles were required by the British Army. The Scorpion was created to meet the requirements of the Combat Vehicle Reconnaissance (Tracked)—CVR(T)—role.

THE SCORPION was part of a family of vehicles with the same engines and transmissions built by British manufacturer Alvis. One of the requirements of the design was air portability: it was clad in aluminum armor to save weight, and two Scorpions could fit in the hold of a C130 Hercules aircraft. Its lightweight design gave its tracks a low ground pressure—in fact, the ground pressure was less than that of a human foot. This lightness meant the Scorpion could travel across soft ground that would have been inaccessible to many other military vehicles, a trait that proved very useful in the British Army’s Falklands campaign in 1982.

The Scorpion was initially equipped with the Jaguar J60 4.2-liter gasoline engine, similar to that of the manufacturer’s famous E-type sports car. Like many British Army vehicles, these engines were later replaced by diesel variants, which were considered safer. The Scorpion was armed with a 76 mm low-velocity gun that could fire a range of projectiles including smoke, High Explosive, High Explosive Squash Head (HESH), and canister rounds. In theory, use of the HESH round gave the Scorpion a tank-killing capability, but its aluminum armor meant it was vulnerable to anything heavier than small-arms fire—it would have to rely on speed and maneuverability to survive engagements with heavier tanks.



REAR VIEW



SPECIFICATIONS	
Name	Scorpion CVR(T)
Date	1973
Origin	UK
Production	Over 3,000
Engine	Cummins BTA 5.9-liter diesel 190 hp
Weight	9 tons (8.1 tonnes)
Main armament	76 mm L23A1
Secondary armament	7.62 mm L34A1
Crew	3
Armor thickness	0.50 in (12.7 mm)

Commander

Gunner

Driver

Engine